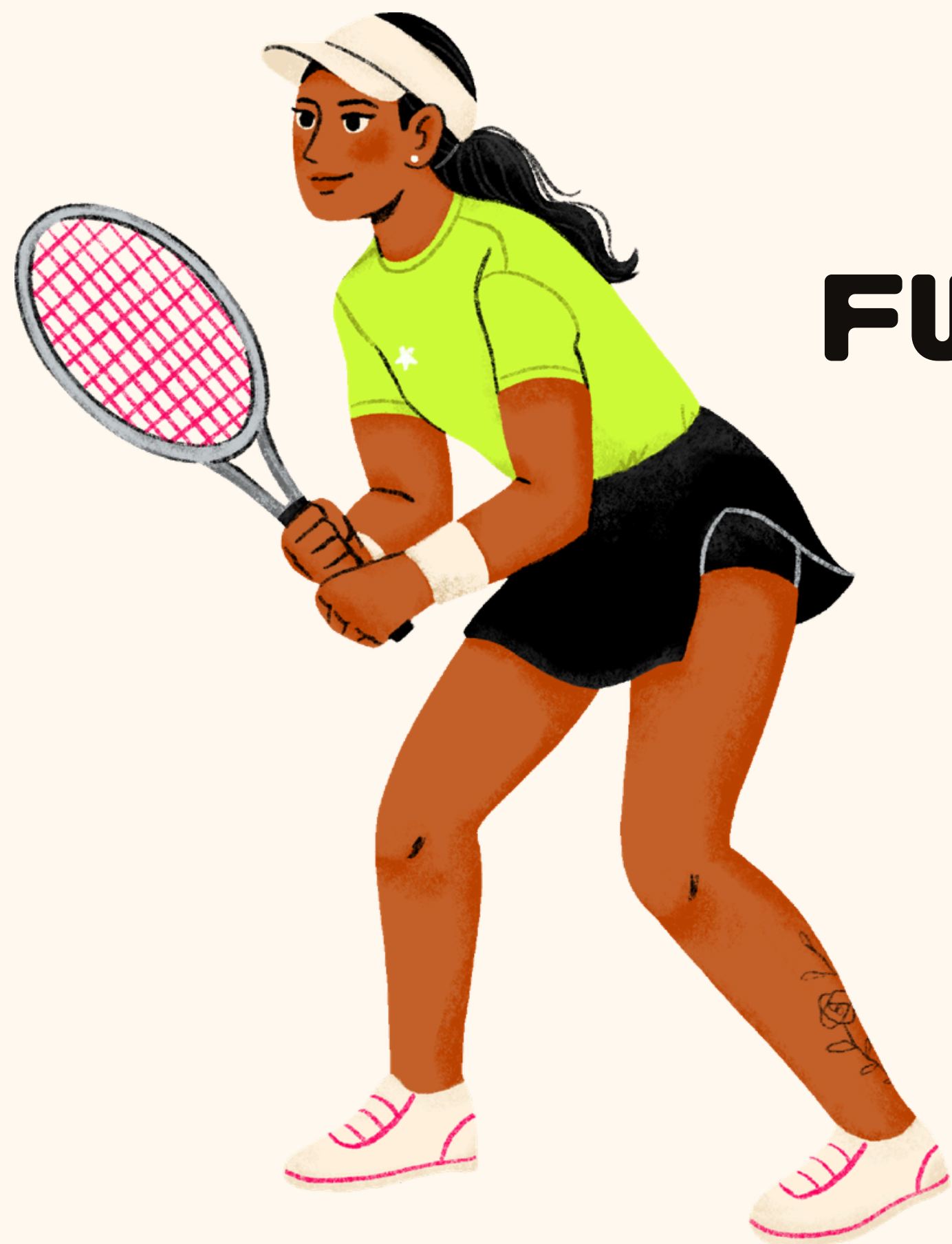




FUNDAMENTAL SKILLS IN

**RAKCE
SPORTS**

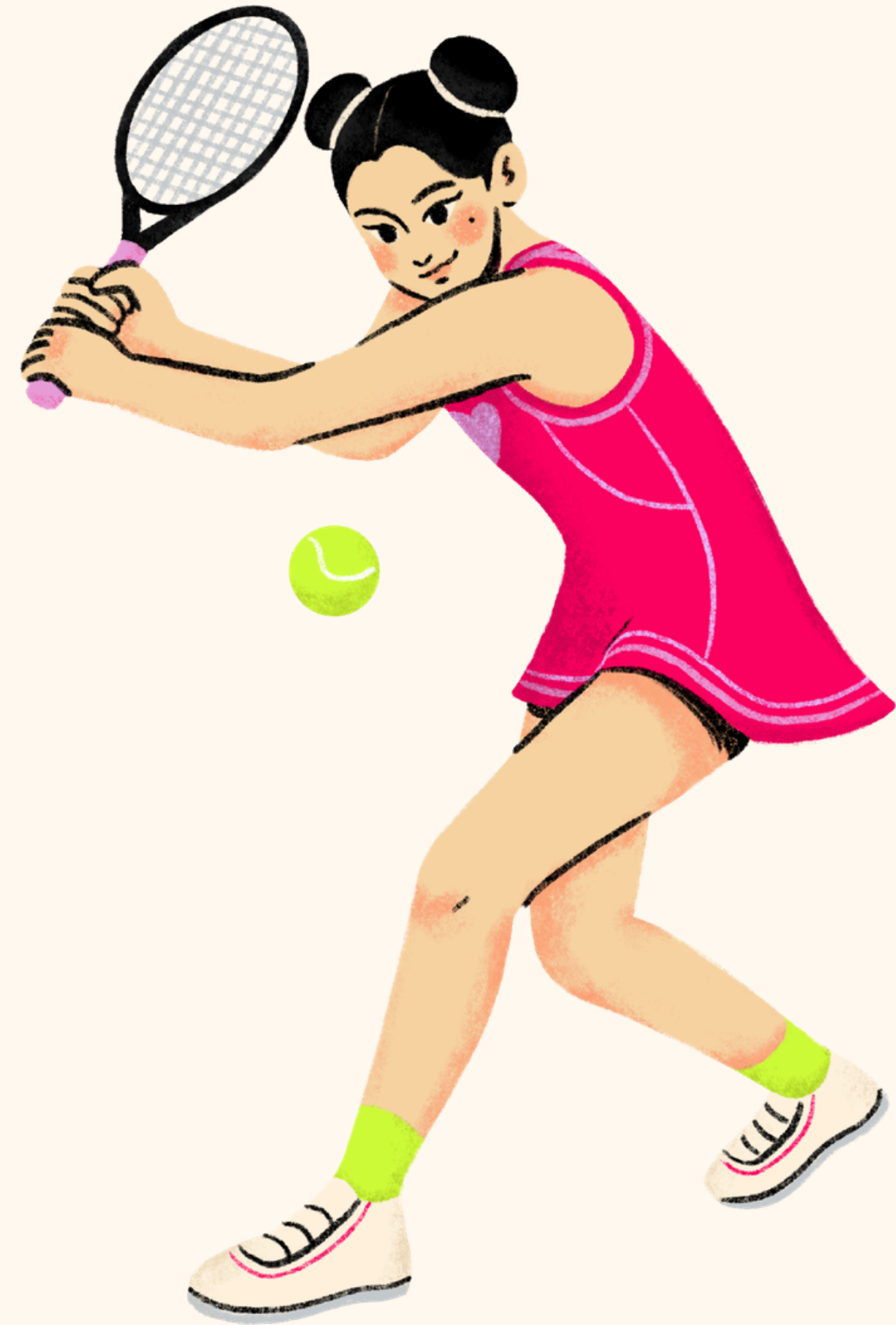
OBJECTIVES

At the end of the session, the students should be able to:

1. Demonstrate the proper ready position, grip, and footwork used in racket sports.
2. Execute forehand and backhand strokes using correct body mechanics and technique.
3. Perform hand-eye coordination and ball-control drills with consistency and accuracy.

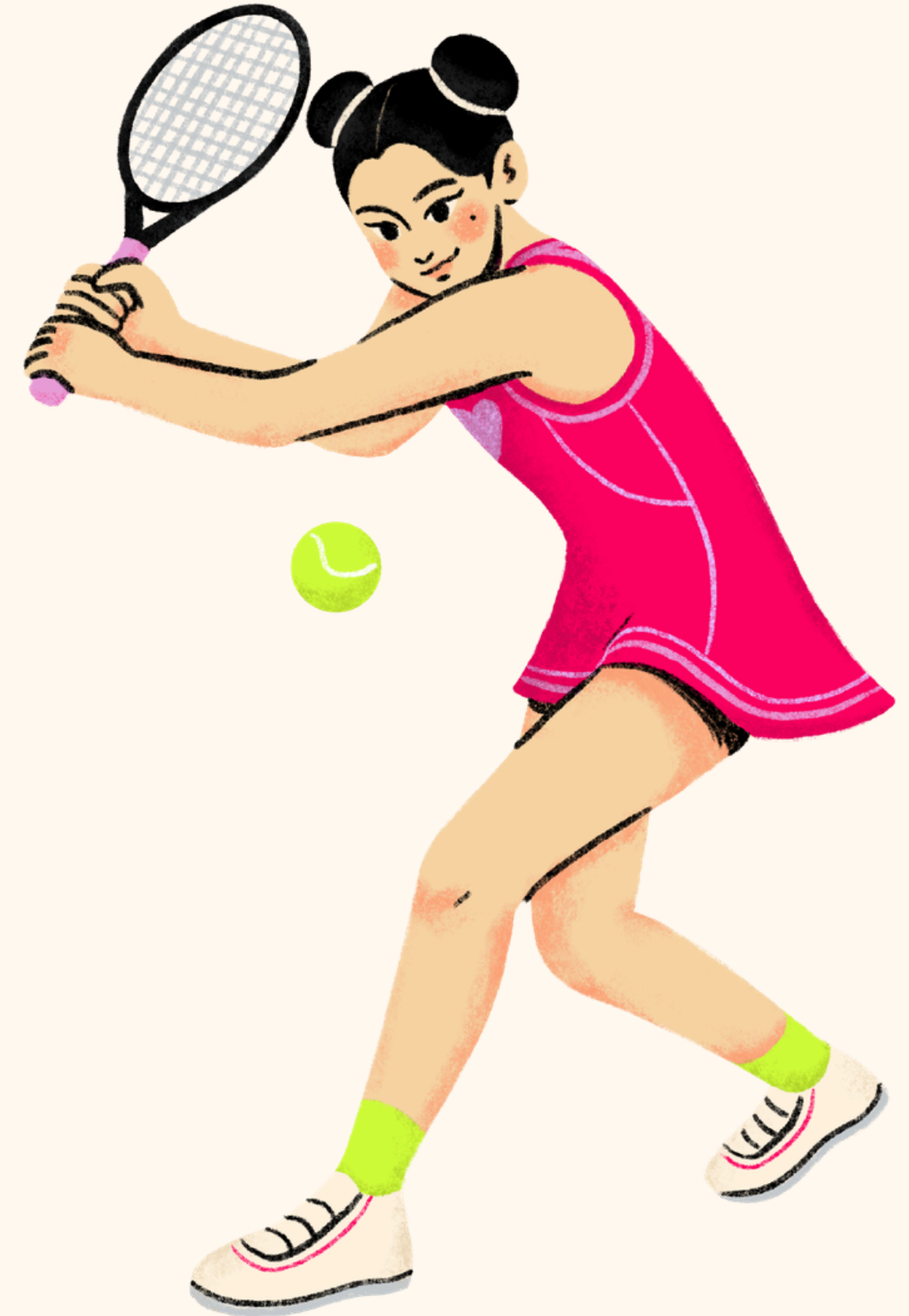
INTRODUCTION

Racket sports are activities in which players use a racket or paddle to hit a ball or shuttlecock.



EXAMPLES

- Tennis
- Badminton
- Table Tennis
- Pickleball
- Squash



DEVELOPING THESE SKILLS HELPS IMPROVE:

- Coordination
- Balance
- Agility
- Reaction time
- Accuracy
- Control
- Speed and movement
- Confidence in playing



1. READY POSITION

- The ready position is the basic body position used before and during play.
- It prepares the player to react quickly to an incoming ball or shuttle.
- The player should maintain a balanced and relaxed posture.



KEY COMPONENTS

- Feet positioned approximately shoulder-width apart.
- Knees slightly bent.
- Weight distributed toward the balls of the feet.
- Body slightly leaning forward.
- Head and eyes facing the opponent or incoming ball.



KEY COMPONENTS

- Racket/paddle held in front of the body.
- Elbows slightly bent and away from the body.
- Maintain a relaxed but alert posture.
- Be ready to move in any direction.





USA Pickleball describes the ready position as a key fundamental, with the paddle held in front of the chest and the player prepared to respond to either a forehand or backhand.



2. PROPER GRIP TECHNIQUES

- Grip refers to how the hand holds the racket or paddle.
- A proper grip provides:
 - Control
 - Stability
 - Accuracy
 - Power
 - Better racket maneuverability
- Grip requirements vary depending on the racket sport and type of stroke.



3. BASIC GRIP PRINCIPLES

- Hold the racket firmly but not excessively tight.
- Keep the wrist relatively relaxed.
- Maintain control of the racket head.
- Avoid squeezing the handle throughout the entire movement.
- Be able to adjust the grip when necessary.

For tennis, USTA emphasizes that excessive gripping can reduce control; beginners should use a relatively relaxed grip.



4. COMMON RACKET GRIPS

1. Continental Grip

- Often called the “hammer” grip.
- Similar to holding a hammer.
- Commonly used for:
 - Serves
 - Volleys
 - Overhead shots
 - Certain defensive shots

In pickleball, the Continental grip is recommended by USA Pickleball as a versatile beginner grip.



4. COMMON RACKET GRIPS

2. Eastern Forehand Grip

- Commonly used for tennis forehand strokes.
- Provides a balance of:
 - Control
 - Power
 - Spin
- Suitable for many beginner players.



4. COMMON RACKET GRIPS

3. Eastern Backhand Grip

- Used primarily for a one-handed tennis backhand.
- Helps position the racket face appropriately for the stroke.



4. COMMON RACKET GRIPS

4. Two-Handed Backhand Grip

- Both hands are placed on the racket handle.
- The non-dominant hand contributes significantly to the stroke.
- Provides: Balance, Control & Power.
- Commonly used in modern tennis.

USTA notes that the two-handed backhand is more common today, with the non-dominant hand playing an important role in the stroke.



5. BASIC FOOTWORK AND COURT MOVEMENT

1. Footwork

Footwork refers to the way a player moves around the court to reach the ball or shuttle.



5. BASIC FOOTWORK AND COURT MOVEMENT

Good footwork allows players to:

- Reach the ball on time.
- Maintain balance.
- Prepare for the stroke.
- Recover quickly.
- Cover the court efficiently.



5. BASIC FOOTWORK AND COURT MOVEMENT

2. Basic Footwork Principles

- Stay light on the feet.
- Keep knees slightly bent.
- Maintain balance while moving.
- Avoid crossing the feet unnecessarily.
- Move toward the ball rather than reaching excessively with the racket.
- Maintain visual focus on the ball/shuttle.
- Recover to an appropriate position after every shot.

USTA recommends staying light on the feet and emphasizes the relationship between footwork and effective stroke preparation.

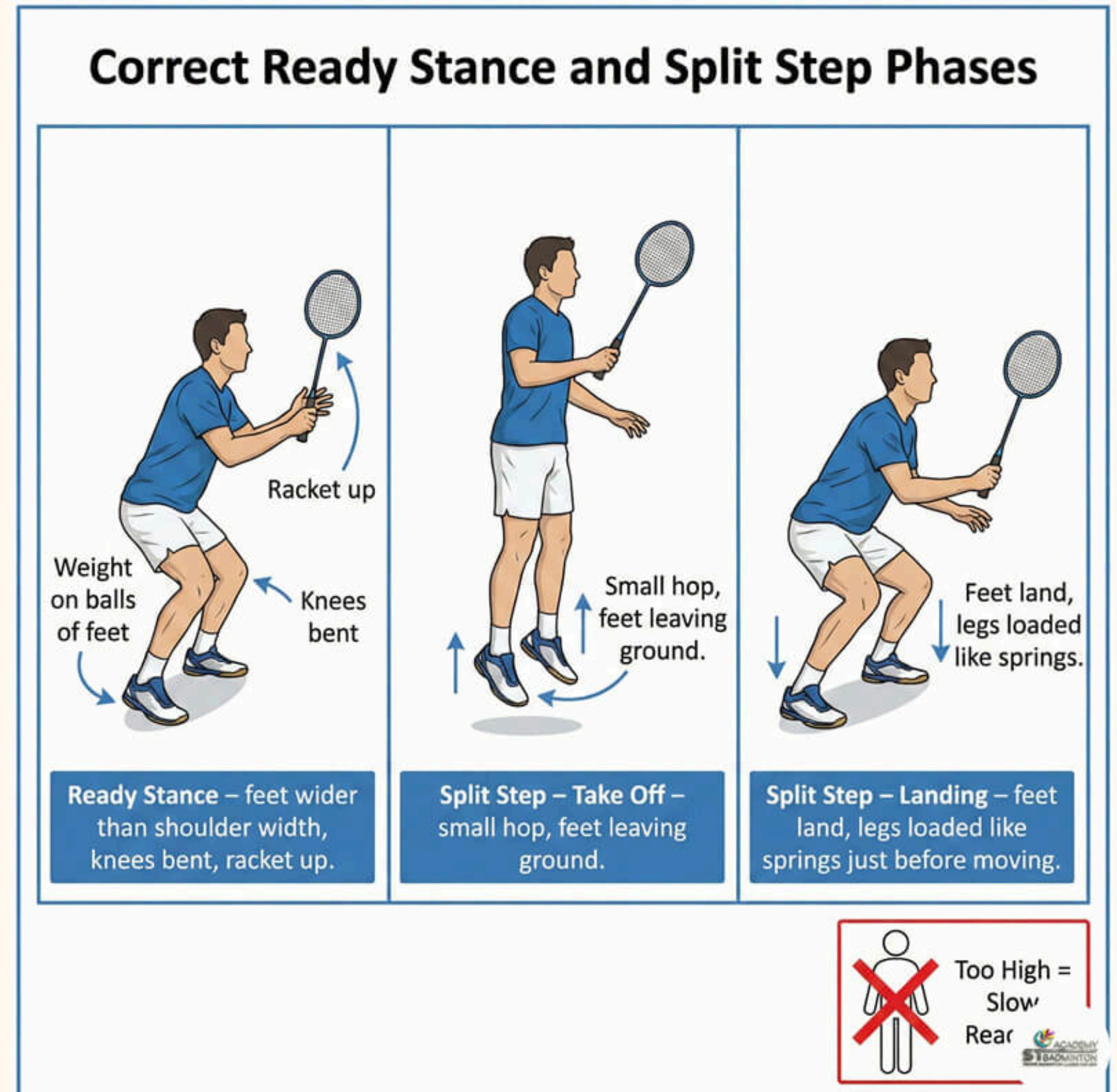


5. BASIC FOOTWORK AND COURT MOVEMENT

Basic Court Movements

1. Split Step

- A small preparatory jump or weight shift.
- Performed as the opponent hits the ball.
- Helps the player react quickly in different directions.



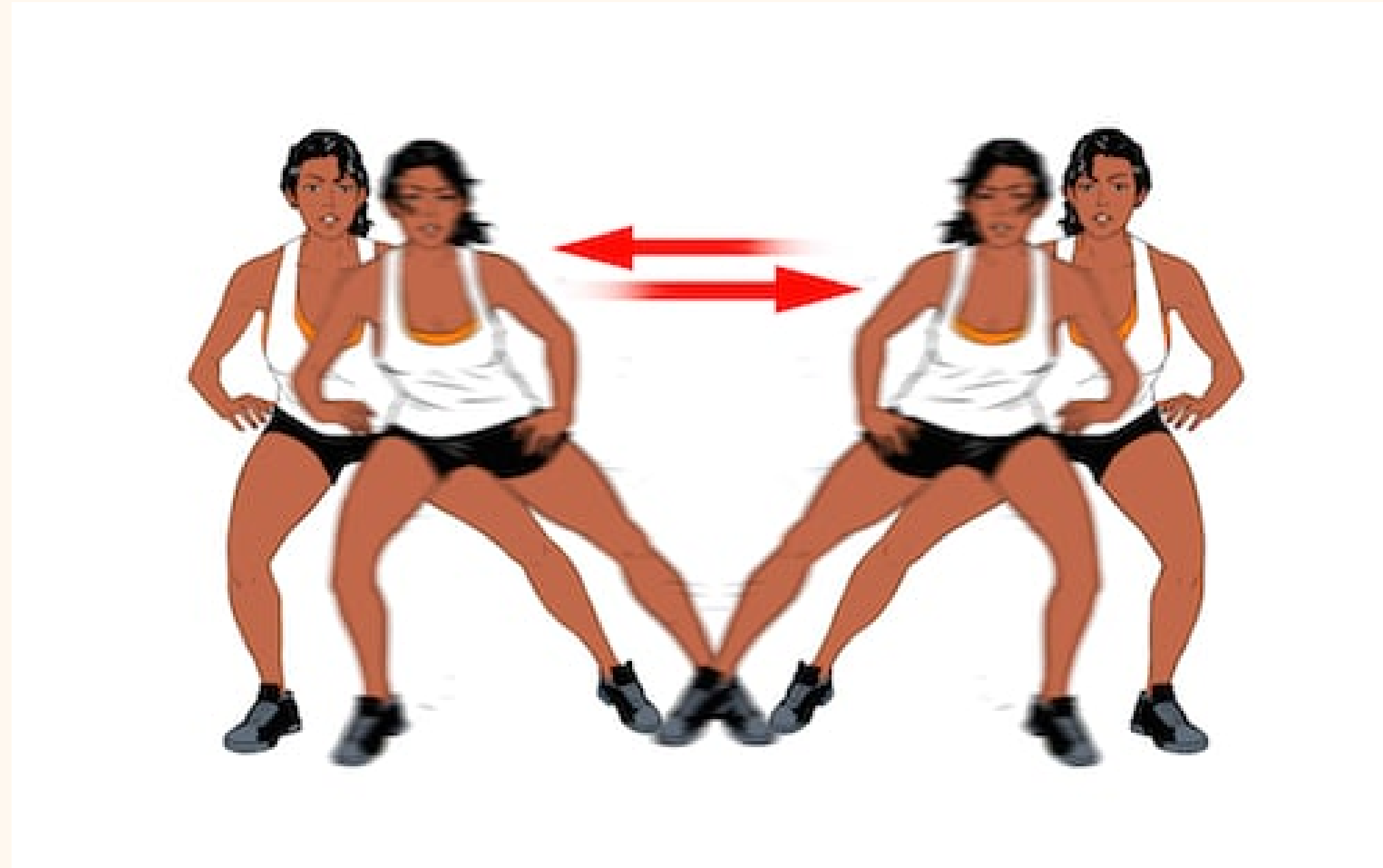
5. BASIC FOOTWORK AND COURT

MOVEMENT

Basic Court Movements

2. Side Shuffle

- Used for lateral movement.
- Feet move sideways without crossing.
- Useful for covering the left and right sides of the court.



5. BASIC FOOTWORK AND COURT MOVEMENT

Basic Court Movements

3. Forward Movement

- Used when approaching a short ball.
- Maintain balance while moving toward the ball.



5. BASIC FOOTWORK AND COURT MOVEMENT

Basic Court Movements

5. Recovery Step

- Movement back toward the appropriate court position after hitting.
- Prepares the player for the opponent's next shot.
- Used when the ball travels behind the player.
- Maintain control and avoid turning completely away from the play.

5. BASIC FOOTWORK AND COURT MOVEMENT

Important Principle

Hit → Recover → Prepare

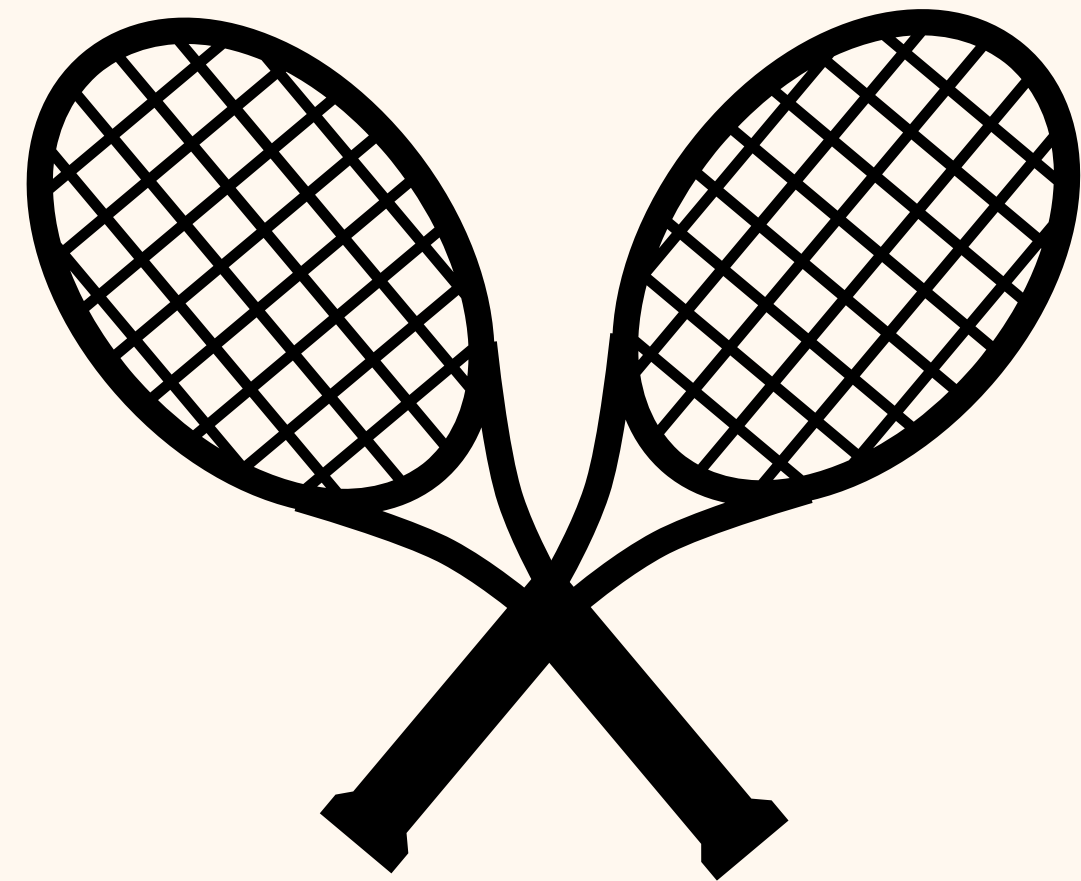
- Execute the stroke.
- Return to a balanced position.
- Prepare for the next shot.

USTA teaching materials specifically reinforce recovering to the ready position after completing a stroke.

6. HAND EYE COORDINATION

Hand-eye coordination is the ability to use visual information to guide hand and racket movements. it is essential for:

- Timing
- Accuracy
- Ball contact
- Racket control
- Reaction speed



Good coordination allows players to make consistent contact with the ball or shuttle.

7. BASIC COORDINATION DRILLS

1. Ball Toss and Catch

- Toss the ball upward.
- Catch it with the same hand.
- Progress by alternating hands.

2. Racket Bounce

- Bounce the ball repeatedly on the racket.
- Keep the racket face stable.
- Count consecutive successful contacts.



7. BASIC COORDINATION DRILLS

4. Wall Rally

- Hit the ball against a wall.
- Maintain a controlled rhythm.
- Gradually increase distance.

5. Partner Toss and Hit

- Partner gently tosses the ball.
- Player attempts to make controlled contact.
- Focus on timing rather than power.



8. FOREHAND STROKE

- The **forehand** is a stroke performed on the dominant side of the body.
- It is one of the most fundamental strokes in many racket sports.
- It is commonly used to:
 - Start rallies
 - Return shots
 - Attack
 - Place the ball
 - Maintain consistency



8. BACKHAND STROKE

- The **backhand** is a stroke performed on the non-dominant side of the body.
- It is used to return balls/shuttles arriving on the backhand side.
- It may be performed using:
 - One hand
 - Two hands
- The two-handed backhand provides additional stability and is widely used in tennis.



8. BALL CONTROL

Ball control is the ability to consistently manipulate and direct the ball using the racket.

It involves:

- Racket control
- Timing
- Touch
- Accuracy
- Force control



The goal is not simply to hit hard but to control where and how the ball travels.

9. BALL CONTROL ACTIVITIES

1. Racket Tapping

- Keep the ball bouncing on the racket.
- Try to maintain a consistent height.

2. Forehand/Backhand Self-Rally

- Bounce/hit the ball repeatedly using the forehand/backhand side.
- Count successful contacts.

9. BALL CONTROL ACTIVITIES

3. Alternating Rally

- Alternate between forehand and backhand.
- Focus on maintaining control

4. Target Hitting

- Place targets on the court.
- Attempt to hit the ball toward the target.



10. PARTNER SKILL DRILLS

1. Partner Toss and Hit

- Player A gently tosses the ball.
- Player B performs a forehand.
- Switch roles.
- Focus on proper technique rather than power.

2. Forehand-to-Forehand Rally

- Partners stand on opposite sides.
- Both players use forehand strokes.
- Aim for continuous controlled rallies.

10. PARTNER SKILL DRILLS

3. Backhand-to-Backhand Rally

- Partners rally using backhand strokes.
- Focus on consistency and control.

4. Forehand/Backhand Alternation

- Player alternates between forehand and backhand.
- Partner directs the ball to different sides.

5 Move and Hit

- Partner directs the ball to different areas.
- Player moves using appropriate footwork.
- Player executes the stroke.
- Player recovers to the ready position.

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THANK
YOU

